Meaningful inclusion in the curriculum

Are marginalised perspectives embedded meaningfully?

WHAT IS IT?

Marginalised perspectives are embedded as substantive, not token

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Teaching is never neutral. Choices about readings, cases, examples, guest speakers, classroom norms and professional pathways tell students whose lives and knowledge are considered normal, legitimate or peripheral. When students cannot recognise themselves or their communities in the discipline, participation can start to feel risky or pointless.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “People like me do not seem to exist in this field.”
- “We only appear when the course is discussing disadvantage or a problem.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Build these perspectives into core concepts, not sidebars or optional extras.
- Connect them to the main learning questions of the course.
- Avoid including a perspective only when discussing disadvantage or diversity itself.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A planning course treats First Nations knowledges as integral to land use and design, rather than a stand-alone “special topic”.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

This course has been designed to embed marginalised perspectives as substantive knowledge rather than isolated or token content. If you notice an avoidable barrier or an important perspective that is missing, tell us through…

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